

OSC DATA RETENTION SCHEDULE

Owner: Legal and Compliance. Applies to all systems processing OSC or customer data.

1. PURPOSE

This schedule defines how long each category of data is retained and what happens at the end of its retention period. Retaining data longer than necessary increases breach impact and regulatory exposure; deleting it too early destroys records OSC is legally required to hold.

2. RETENTION PERIODS

Customer account records are retained for 7 years after the account is closed. This period is set by financial record-keeping obligations and cannot be shortened by a deletion request.

Application logs are retained for 90 days in hot storage and a further 275 days in cold storage, giving a total retention of 12 months.

Security audit logs are retained for 24 months. They are written to append-only storage and cannot be modified or deleted before that period expires.

Email and instant messaging records are retained for 3 years.

Recruitment records for unsuccessful candidates are retained for 12 months, after which they are deleted unless the candidate has consented to a longer talent-pool retention of 24 months.

Backup snapshots are retained for 35 days. A deletion request is satisfied when the record is removed from live systems; backups age out naturally within 35 days and are not edited to remove individual records.

3. DELETION

Deletion at end of life is permanent and irreversible. Records are destroyed, not anonymised, unless a specific analytical need has been approved by the Data Protection Officer.

Deletion jobs run on the first Sunday of each month. A deletion that fails raises a SEV3 incident and must be resolved before the next monthly run.

4. LEGAL HOLD

A legal hold suspends all deletion for the records it covers, including scheduled end-of-life deletion. Legal holds are applied and released only by the General Counsel. A record under legal hold is retained until the hold is released, however long that takes.